

CATHARSIS 14-DAY WORKSHOP

The Emotional Burnout Reset

A two-week workshop for recovering from emotional depletion, reducing invisible load, and rebuilding energy without forcing yourself back into performance.

14 days of teaching, reflection, scripts, tiny practices, and on-screen reset pages. About 5 minutes a day.

START HERE

Burnout is not only tiredness. It is prolonged self-override.

Emotional burnout often happens when you keep functioning while your inner life is asking for care. You may still answer messages, meet deadlines, support people, and look fine from the outside.

This workshop helps you identify depletion, reduce emotional load, restore basic regulation, and rebuild capacity slowly enough that recovery does not become another performance.

You are not lazy for needing repair. You are a nervous system that has been carrying too much for too long.

Recovery begins when you stop treating your depletion like a character flaw.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Use this as education, not therapy

This guide is for reflection, emotional education, and self-support. It is not therapy, diagnosis, medical advice, or a substitute for professional care.

If your distress feels unmanageable, you feel unsafe, or daily life is becoming hard to function through, speak with a qualified mental health professional or local crisis support.

For digital use, open the PDF in Apple Preview, Adobe Reader, Chrome, Edge, or the Google Drive PDF viewer and type directly into the writable boxes. Google Docs may flatten PDF forms, so use the Drive preview/editor instead of converting the file to a Doc.

If you print it, choose black-and-white or grayscale settings to save ink. Aim for about 5 minutes a day; short, honest answers are better than perfect answers.

THE MAP

What the 14 days are really training

The reset moves from honest assessment into load reduction, nervous-system repair, energy rebuilding, and relapse prevention.

PHASE 1

Assess depletion

Name the emotional, physical, relational, and cognitive signs without minimizing them.

PHASE 2

Reduce invisible load

Find what you are carrying that no one sees, thanks you for, or helps you hold.

PHASE 3

Restore capacity

Use small repeatable practices that make the body feel less hunted.

PHASE 4

Protect the recovery

Build rules that stop burnout from becoming your default operating system again.

SCRIPTS

Scripts for protecting recovery

CAPACITY

I want to give this proper attention, and I do not have the capacity today.

DELAY

I can talk about this, but not tonight. I need rest before I can be useful here.

HANDOFF

Can you take over this specific piece? I am at capacity and need it off my plate.

SIMPLIFY

I am going to do the smaller version this week so I can actually recover.

EMOTIONAL PACING

I care, and I need to pause before this becomes too much for me.

RELAPSE PREVENTION

When I start functioning on fumes, I need to subtract before I add anything else.

BEFORE YOU START

Mark your starting point

This is not a scorecard. It is a snapshot you can return to after the final day.

Right now, my emotional burnout reset intensity is: 0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7
8 9 10

The pattern I most want to shift is:

If this workshop helps, I hope I will notice:

Admit the real level of tired

Burnout recovery starts with honesty. Not the polished version. The private version that knows how much effort normal tasks are taking.

Rate your emotional, physical, mental, and social energy from 1 to 10.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Admit the real level of tired

TODAY'S RESET

Rate your emotional, physical, mental, and social energy from 1 to 10.

Today's reset pairs with the Burnout Signals deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

Emotional energy:

Physical energy:

What I have been minimizing:

Map the invisible load

Invisible load is the planning, anticipating, remembering, soothing, translating, checking, and managing that drains you before anything visible happens.

Write everything you are carrying that does not show up on a calendar.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Map the invisible load

TODAY'S RESET

Write everything you are carrying that does not show up on a calendar.

Today's reset pairs with the Invisible Load deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

The invisible tasks are:

The emotional roles I keep playing are:

The heaviest unseen load is:

Find your burnout tells

Burnout has tells: irritability, numbness, avoidance, cynicism, shallow breathing, messy sleep, decision fatigue, or the urge to disappear.

Circle your top three tells and choose one early warning sign.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Find your burnout tells

TODAY'S RESET

Circle your top three tells and choose one early warning sign.

Today's reset pairs with the Warning Signs deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

My top burnout tells are:

My earliest warning sign is:

When this appears, I need:

Stop confusing rest with collapse

If you only rest when you crash, your body learns rest means emergency.
Recovery needs rest before collapse.

Schedule one 20-minute non-productive rest block before you
feel desperate.

**Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without
trying to make the answer perfect.**

Stop confusing rest with collapse

TODAY'S RESET

Schedule one 20-minute non-productive rest block before you feel desperate.

Today's reset pairs with the Rest deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

Rest before collapse would look like:

What makes rest feel hard:

How I will protect 20 minutes:

Lower the demand for one day

Burnout asks for subtraction before optimization. You do not need a better routine before you remove something unnecessary.

Cancel, postpone, simplify, or delegate one demand today.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Lower the demand for one day

TODAY'S RESET

Cancel, postpone, simplify, or delegate one demand today.

Today's reset pairs with the Subtraction deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

The demand I can lower is:

The fear that resists lowering it is:

What lowering it gives back to me:

Feed the body signal

Emotional burnout often blunts basic body cues. Food, water, light, movement, and sleep are not shallow fixes; they are safety data.

Choose one body cue to answer before it becomes extreme.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Feed the body signal

TODAY'S RESET

Choose one body cue to answer before it becomes extreme.

Today's reset pairs with the Body Cues deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

The cue I ignore most is:

Today I answered it by:

My body responded with:

Create a no-input pocket

Constant input keeps the nervous system processing. A no-input pocket gives your mind a chance to stop metabolizing everyone else's noise.

Spend 15 minutes with no phone, podcast, music, reading, or problem-solving.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Create a no-input pocket

TODAY'S RESET

Spend 15 minutes with no phone, podcast, music, reading, or problem-solving.

Today's reset pairs with the No-Input deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

Before the pocket I felt:

During it I noticed:

After it I felt:

Name the emotional debt

Emotional debt builds when you postpone grief, anger, disappointment, fear, or loneliness because there is no room to feel it.

Let one postponed feeling have language without fixing it.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Name the emotional debt

TODAY'S RESET

Let one postponed feeling have language without fixing it.

Today's reset pairs with the Emotional Debt deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

The feeling I postponed is:

It makes sense because:

What it needs from me is:

Ask for a practical handoff

Support works best when it is specific. Burnout makes broad asking feel impossible, so choose one concrete handoff.

Ask someone to take, change, decide, remind, pick up, or handle one specific thing.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Ask for a practical handoff

TODAY'S RESET

Ask someone to take, change, decide, remind, pick up, or handle one specific thing.

Today's reset pairs with the Receiving Help deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

The task I need help with is:

The exact ask is:

Receiving help felt like:

Rebuild one small ritual

Recovery is not a total life overhaul. It often starts with one ritual that tells your body the day has edges.

Create a tiny opening or closing ritual for the day.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Rebuild one small ritual

TODAY'S RESET

Create a tiny opening or closing ritual for the day.

Today's reset pairs with the Rituals deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

My ritual is:

It takes this many minutes:

The edge it creates is:

Protect your attention

Burnout makes attention feel shredded. You may not need more discipline; you may need fewer open loops.

Close three loops: tabs, notifications, unresolved small tasks, or pending replies.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Protect your attention

TODAY'S RESET

Close three loops: tabs, notifications, unresolved small tasks, or pending replies.

Today's reset pairs with the Attention deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

The open loops were:

I closed them by:

My attention felt:

Practice emotional pacing

You do not owe every hard conversation your full capacity the moment it appears. Pacing is care, not avoidance.

Delay or shorten one emotionally expensive conversation.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Practice emotional pacing

TODAY'S RESET

Delay or shorten one emotionally expensive conversation.

Today's reset pairs with the Pacing deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

The conversation is:

The pacing boundary is:

What I can offer instead is:

Design a relapse warning plan

A relapse plan is not pessimistic. It is respectful of your patterns.

Write your early signs, required subtraction, and who to tell.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Design a relapse warning plan

TODAY'S RESET

Write your early signs, required subtraction, and who to tell.

Today's reset pairs with the Relapse Plan deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

My early signs are:

The first thing I must subtract is:

The person or support to tell is:

Choose sustainable re-entry

The goal is not to feel better and immediately spend all the energy.

Recovery needs a slower re-entry than your ambition may prefer.

Choose one rule for the next 30 days that protects your capacity.

Read first. Then do the exercise on the next page without trying to make the answer perfect.

Choose sustainable re-entry

TODAY'S RESET

Choose one rule for the next 30 days that protects your capacity.

Today's reset pairs with the Sustainable Re-Entry deck in the Catharsis Cards app.

Write the honest version, not the polished version. Short answers still count.

My 30-day rule is:

It protects me from:

I will know it is working when:

WHERE YOU ARE NOW

Compare the shift

Use the same questions from day zero so the change is visible, even if the shift is small.

Today, my emotional burnout reset intensity is: 0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8
9 10

Compared with day zero, I can see:

The reset I want to keep using is:

Daily workshop tracker

Tap or annotate one short note per day. Keep it short enough to complete even on a messy day.

Day	Body cue	Old pattern	Reset used	What I learned
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				
9				
10				
11				
12				
13				
14				

FINISHING NOTE

You are not behind. You are rebuilding capacity.

Emotional burnout recovery is allowed to be slow, ordinary, and imperfect. The point is not to become endlessly available again. The point is to build a life where your energy is listened to before it has to disappear.

I can recover without earning rest through collapse.

RESOURCES

Continue with Catharsis

Keep going with the app, or visit Catharsis for more reflection tools.

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**One prompt. One honest answer. One small act
of self-trust.**